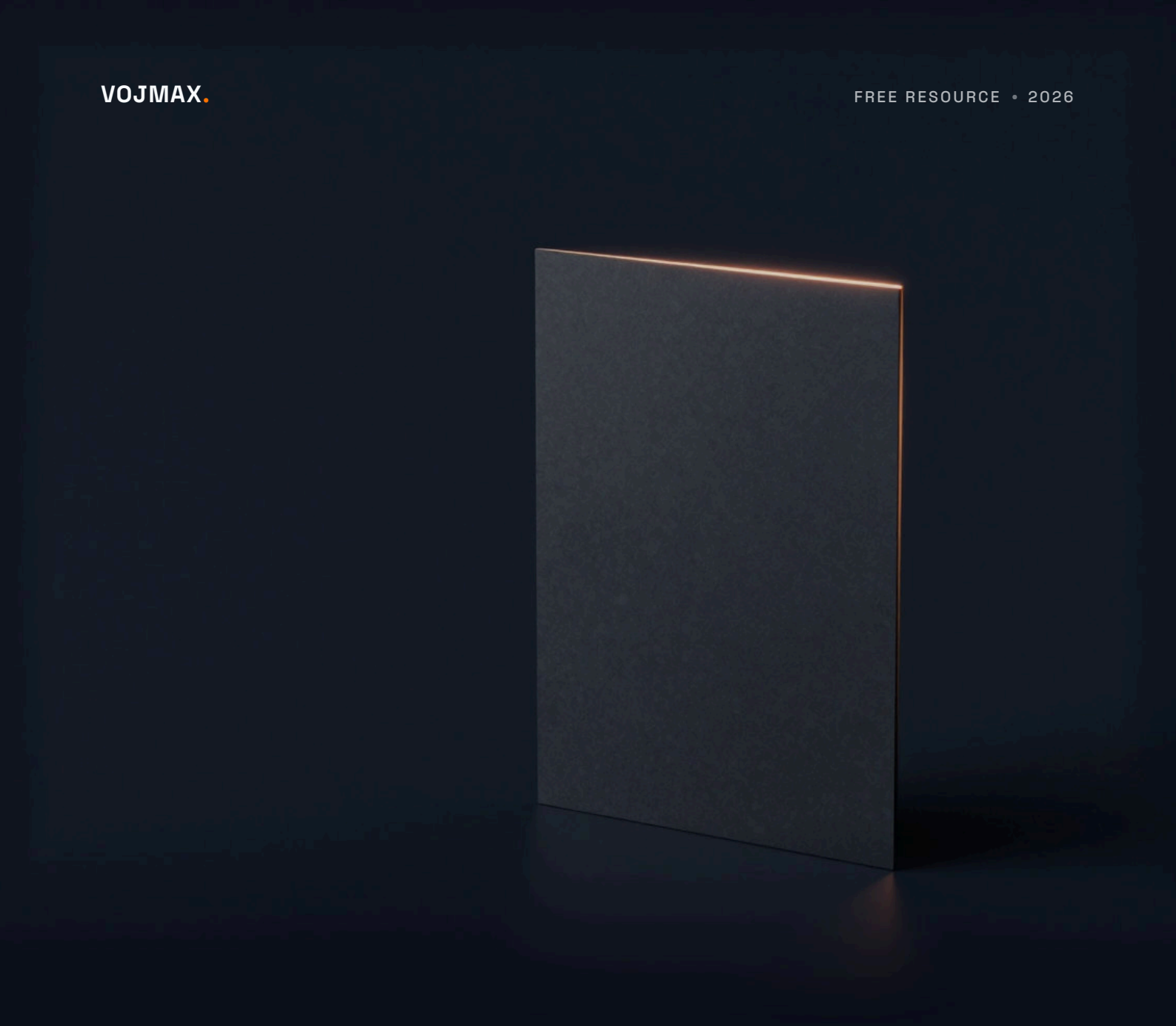
VOJMAX.

FREE RESOURCE • 2026



WEBSITE LAUNCH & HANDOVER

LAUNCH CHECKLIST

The pre-launch and post-launch checks I run before handing a website over to a client.

VOJMAX.
Victor James

SECTIONS	CHECKS	FORMAT
13	157	A4, print or screen

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this checklist

This is the list I work through before a website goes live and gets handed over. It covers the things that are easy to miss at the end of a project, when everyone is ready to launch and nobody wants to test the footer links again.

1

Work through it in order

Content and design come first, technical checks after, launch day last. Problems get more expensive the later they're found.

2

Tick it, or mark it N/A

Not every item applies to every site. Strike through what doesn't, so an empty box always means "not checked yet".

3

Sign it off

Page 09 is the launch record. Fill it in, keep it with the project files and share a copy with the client.

☐ Not checked yet ☑ Done ⊟ Not applicable

PROJECT DETAILS

PROJECT

CLIENT

WEBSITE ADDRESS

PLATFORM / HOSTING

TARGET LAUNCH DATE

CHECKED BY

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01 Project basics

Sign-offs first. Nothing else on this list matters if the client is still expecting changes.

- [ ] Final design approved
- [ ] Final content approved
- [ ] All requested pages are complete
- [ ] Navigation structure is finalised
- [ ] Logo and brand assets are correct
- [ ] Contact information is correct
- [ ] Business information is accurate
- [ ] Legal pages are present where required
- [ ] Client has approved the final version

02 Content

Read every page the way a visitor would. Placeholder copy hides in the places nobody opens: footers, error states, thank-you pages.

- [ ] Page titles are correct
- [ ] Headings follow a logical hierarchy
- [ ] Body copy has been proofread
- [ ] No placeholder text remains
- [ ] Images replaced with final assets
- [ ] Images are properly cropped
- [ ] Images have appropriate alt text
- [ ] Buttons have clear labels
- [ ] Links point to the correct destinations
- [ ] Phone numbers are clickable where appropriate
- [ ] Email addresses are correct
- [ ] Social media links are correct
- [ ] Pricing and service information is accurate
- [ ] Copyright information is current

NOTES

03 Responsive design

Drag the window slowly between sizes, not just to the presets. Layouts tend to break between breakpoints, not on them.

CHECK THE SITE AT

- [ ] **Mobile** 375 px
- [ ] **Tablet** 768 px
- [ ] **Laptop** 1280 px
- [ ] **Desktop** 1440 px
- [ ] **Large desktop** 1920 px +

THEN CHECK

- [ ] No horizontal scrolling
- [ ] Navigation works correctly
- [ ] Mobile menu opens, closes and links
- [ ] Text remains readable
- [ ] Buttons are comfortably tappable
- [ ] Images scale correctly
- [ ] Sections don't overlap
- [ ] Cards and components don't break
- [ ] Forms work on mobile
- [ ] Spacing remains consistent
- [ ] Footer works correctly

04 Accessibility

Put the mouse away and tab through every page. If you can't reach something or can't see where you are, some visitors can't either.

- [ ] Sufficient colour contrast
- [ ] Logical heading hierarchy
- [ ] Images have useful alt text
- [ ] Decorative images are hidden from screen readers
- [ ] Keyboard navigation works
- [ ] Visible focus states exist
- [ ] Form fields have labels
- [ ] Buttons are understandable
- [ ] Links are descriptive
- [ ] Interactive elements work without a mouse
- [ ] Text is readable at normal zoom
- [ ] No important information relies only on colour

05 SEO

Check what search engines and social apps see: the page source, the sitemap and the preview a shared link makes.

- [ ] Page titles are unique and descriptive
- [ ] Meta descriptions are present
- [ ] One H1 per page, correctly used
- [ ] Heading hierarchy is logical
- [ ] URLs are clean
- [ ] Canonical URLs configured where needed
- [ ] Sitemap exists
- [ ] Robots.txt is configured correctly
- [ ] Important pages are indexable
- [ ] Unwanted pages are not accidentally indexed
- [ ] Open Graph metadata is configured
- [ ] Social sharing image is configured
- [ ] Favicon is present
- [ ] Structured data implemented where appropriate

06 Performance

Test on a real phone over mobile data, not only on a fast desktop connection.

- [ ] Images are compressed
- [ ] Images use appropriate formats
- [ ] Images are appropriately sized
- [ ] Fonts are optimised
- [ ] Unused assets are removed
- [ ] JavaScript is minimised where appropriate
- [ ] CSS is optimised
- [ ] Third-party scripts are reviewed
- [ ] Lazy loading used where appropriate
- [ ] Page loading has been tested
- [ ] Core Web Vitals have been reviewed
- [ ] No obvious performance bottlenecks remain

NOTES

07 Forms & functionality

Submit every form with real details, then check the inbox that will actually receive them. Test the failures too.

- [ ] Contact forms submit successfully
- [ ] Form validation works
- [ ] Error messages work
- [ ] Success states work
- [ ] Email notifications are received
- [ ] Auto-replies work where applicable
- [ ] Booking systems work
- [ ] Search works where applicable
- [ ] Filters work where applicable
- [ ] Interactive components work
- [ ] Buttons perform their intended actions
- [ ] No broken interactions remain

08 Links & navigation

Click everything once. Links break quietly, and visitors rarely report them.

- [ ] Every navigation item works
- [ ] Internal links work
- [ ] External links work
- [ ] Footer links work
- [ ] Social links work
- [ ] No broken links
- [ ] 404 page exists
- [ ] Redirects work
- [ ] Old URLs redirect where necessary
- [ ] Logo links to the homepage

NOTES

09 Browser & device testing

Use real devices where you can, with the console open. Emulators are a good start, not the finish.

TEST ACROSS

☐ Chrome Desktop	☐ Safari Desktop	☐ Firefox Desktop	☐ Edge Desktop	☐ iOS Safari	☐ Android Chrome

CHECK

- ☐ Layout consistency
- ☐ Typography
- ☐ Animations
- ☐ Forms
- ☐ Navigation
- ☐ Media
- ☐ Interactive elements
- ☐ Console errors
- ☐ Browser-specific issues

10 Security & technical

Assume anything shipped to the browser can be read. Keys, tokens and admin routes belong on the server.

- ☐ HTTPS is active
- ☐ Domain is correctly connected
- ☐ SSL certificate is valid
- ☐ Environment variables are secure
- ☐ API keys are not exposed
- ☐ Admin credentials are not public
- ☐ Debug information is removed
- ☐ Dependencies are reviewed
- ☐ CMS and admin accounts are secured
- ☐ Backups exist where appropriate
- ☐ Production is separate from development

NOTES

11 Analytics & tracking

Trigger each event yourself and watch it arrive in the dashboard. An untested tag is a guess.

- [ ] Analytics installed
- [ ] Analytics tracking tested
- [ ] Conversion events configured where required
- [ ] Contact and lead conversions tracked
- [ ] Search Console configured where appropriate
- [ ] Cookie and consent requirements reviewed
- [ ] Tracking scripts tested

Issues log

Anything that fails a check goes here, with who is fixing it. Tick it off when it's fixed and checked again.

#	ISSUE	PAGE / AREA	OWNER	FIXED
01				☐
02				☐
03				☐
04				☐
05				☐
06				☐
07				☐
08				☐
09				☐

NOTES

12

Final pre-launch

The last pass on launch day. Everything here has been checked once already. This is the confirmation, in one place.

- [ ] Client has approved the final website
- [ ] Final backup completed
- [ ] Production environment checked
- [ ] Domain confirmed
- [ ] SSL confirmed
- [ ] Forms tested
- [ ] Analytics tested
- [ ] SEO basics checked
- [ ] Mobile version checked
- [ ] Desktop version checked
- [ ] Final links checked
- [ ] No placeholder content remains
- [ ] No major console errors
- [ ] Final deployment completed

LAUNCH RECORD

Complete on launch day. Keep a copy with the project files.

PROJECT

CLIENT

LAUNCH DATE

FINAL CHECKED BY

OPEN ITEMS / NOTES

STATUS ☐ READY TO LAUNCH ☐ NEEDS REVISION

13

Post-launch

The first week after launch. Real visitors find what testing missed, so check again once they arrive.

- [ ] Homepage tested after deployment
- [ ] Forms tested again
- [ ] Analytics receiving data
- [ ] Search indexing checked
- [ ] Broken links checked
- [ ] Mobile version checked
- [ ] Client has received access
- [ ] Client has received handover information
- [ ] Backup confirmed
- [ ] Any launch issues documented
- [ ] Follow-up scheduled

First-week check-ins

Three short check-ins after launch. Fill in the date as you go.

WHEN	DATE	CHECKED BY	NOTES
Day 1			
Day 3			
Day 7			

NOTES

FOR THE CLIENT FILE

Handover notes

CLIENT NOTES

FOLLOW-UP ITEMS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

POST-LAUNCH NOTES

VOJMAX.

Launching a website soon?

I design and build brands and websites for service businesses, from the name and the logo through to the deployed site. If you'd like help getting yours ready for launch, get in touch.

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